

DevNexus | AgileBridge



UNITRADE



Branding Guide

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Brand Overview

Introduction

Scope

UniTrade is a web and mobile platform designed to connect university students who want to buy and sell second-hand academic materials. Built for the South African university context, where students face significant financial pressure from high tuition fees and expensive prescribed textbooks, the system provides a safe, verified, and cost-effective marketplace for books and study resources. Currently, students either purchase new materials at full price or rely on informal networks to find second-hand options, which is unreliable and often unsafe. UniTrade solves this by introducing a structured platform where students can list, browse, and purchase used materials directly from verified peers. The system includes AI-assisted listing verification, OTP based student authentication, real-time chat, GPS meetup coordination, and OZOW payment processing.

Mission

Our mission is to build the most trusted peer-to-peer student marketplace in South Africa; a platform designed from the ground up around the real conditions of student life. We do this by verifying every user through their institution, using intelligent systems to ensure listings are honest and accurate, and facilitating safe, in-person transactions on the campuses students already call home. We remove the friction, the risk, and the guesswork that has always made second-hand textbook trading harder than it needs to be. Through fair access, transparent reputation systems, and technology that works quietly in the background, we give every student, buyer or seller, the confidence to transact with a stranger and walk away satisfied. We are not just building a marketplace. We are building the infrastructure for a student community that looks out for itself.

Vision

A South Africa where no university student has to choose between buying textbooks and covering their basic needs. Where the knowledge required to succeed academically is never locked behind a price tag that only some can afford, and where students who came before naturally becomes the ones who make it easier for the students who follow. We envision a campus culture of exchange, one where trust is built between peers, where verified identities replace blind faith, and where the simple act of passing on a textbook becomes part of something larger: a connected, self-sustaining student economy that grows stronger with every semester.

1. Logo



1.1 Logo Components

The Unitrade logo consists of one element (arranged horizontally or stacked depending on space):

- Icon mark

1.2 Logo spacing rules

The logo must always have breathing room. No text, graphics, or UI elements may intrude into this zone.

1.3 Minimum Size

To ensure legibility on all screens and print materials:

Context	Minimum width
Desktop / tablet website	120px (wordmark + icon)
Mobile website / app header	90px (icon + abbreviated wordmark is needed)
Printed collateral (business cards, flyers)	25mm (approximately 1 inch)
Favicon / app icon	32x32 px (icon only, no wordmark)

1.4 Logo Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Use the logo as provided	Stretch or distort the logo disproportionately
Always maintain clear space	Change the logo colours except to approved mono versions (white or black)
Use the reversed (white) version on dark backgrounds (where applicable)	Place the logo on busy photography without a solid backing or scrim
Scale the logo proportionally	Rotate the logo or tilt it
Use the icon alone as a favicon or badge	Add drop shadows, glows, or outlines to the logo

2. Colour Palette

Role	Hex Code	RGB	Usage
Primary Blue	#1b75bc	(27, 117, 188)	Main brand colour – headers, primary buttons, key accents
Secondary Lighter Blue	#00aeef	(0, 174, 239)	Secondary elements: borders, inactive states, certain UI accents
Accent Dark Blue	#262262	(38, 34, 98)	Higher-contrast accents: footer backgrounds, emphasised text, hover states
Neutral White	#FFFFFF	(255, 255, 255)	Backgrounds, cards, text on dark colours
Neutral Black	#000000	(0, 0, 0)	Body text (primary), dark UI elements

2.1 Colour Usage Ratios (When to use which colour, and how much)

Colour	Target proportion (per screen)	Typical use cases
Neutral White	~60%	Backgrounds, card surfaces, form fields, chart bubbles
Primary Blue	~25%	Header bar, primary buttons, active nav states, key illustrations, “Buy” / “Sell” tags
Neutral Black	~10%	Body text, headings (with extra care), input borders
Secondary Lighter Blue	~4%	Secondary buttons (outline), dividers, “Interested” badge, chat timestamps
Accent Dark Blue	~1%	Footer backgrounds, emergency alerts, admin tools, hover on primary buttons

Interactive states:

- Primary button background: #1b75bc → hover: #262262
- Secondary button outline: #00aeef → hover: fill #00aeef with white text
- Links: #1b75bc underlined on hover

3. Typography Hierarchy

The fonts to be used are all free for web (still need to do research for mobile):

- Inter (headings) + Inter (body) – unified
- Poppins (headings) + Open Sans (body)

Element	Font weight	Size	Line height	Letter spacing	Colour
H1 (Page title)	Bold (700)	2.5rem / 40px	1.2	-0.02em	#000000
H2 (Section Heading)	Semi-bold (600)	2rem / 32px	1.3	-0.01em	#000000
H3 (Card title)	Semi-bold (600)	1.5rem / 24px	1.4	normal	#1b75bc
Subheading	Medium (500)	1.25rem / 20px	1.4	normal	#00aeef
Body text (large)	Regular (400)	1.125rem / 18px	1.5	normal	#000000
Body text (standard)	Regular (400)	1rem / 16px	1.5	normal	#000000
Small text (meta, timestamps, captions)	Regular (400)	0.875 rem / 14px	1.4	normal	Black 60%
Button / label	Medium (500)	1rem / 16px	1.2	+0.02em	White on dark backgrounds

4. Additional Brand Elements

4.1 UI Components (quick reference)

Component	Background	Text	Border / accent
Primary Button	#1b75bc	White	#262262 on hover
Secondary Button	White	#1b75bc	#1b75bc border
Card border	White	#000000	#00aeef 1px solid (light)
Buyer chat bubble	White	#000000	Subtle shadow
Seller chat bubble	#1b75bc	White	none
“Report listing” link	transparent	#262262	Underline on hover

4.2 Imagery & Photography

- Subjects: Real students (Sount African campuses), study sessions, meetups at libraries/cafes, textbook close-ups, phone showing app screens.
- Treatment: Warm, natural light. No heavy filters. Overlays can be used over hero images to ensure text contrast.
- Avoid: Stock photos of generic “businesspeople” or foreign campuses.

4.3 Tone of Voice (Messaging Principles)

- Trustworthy but not cold – e.g., “we verify, you trade safely” not “we are not responsible”
- Student-first, not academic – Short sentences, active voice. “Check in when you arrive” instead of “Location verification shall be performed”
- Direct about rules – No fine-print hiding.